

Community Legislative Brief Template

Turn community narratives into legislative briefs that lawmakers actually read.

A legislative brief is a 1–3 page document presenting a specific policy ask to a legislator or committee. It must be concise, evidence-based, and action-oriented.

1. Issue Summary (50 words max)

State the problem in plain language a non-expert understands in 30 seconds.

2. Affected Population Data

Who Is Affected	(demographic, geographic, economic description)
How Many People	(cite source)
Geographic Scope	(city, county, state, legislative district)
Equity Impact	(how does this disproportionately affect specific communities?)
NOTE: "347 families in your district are affected" beats any national statistic when talking to a local legislator.	

3. The Policy Ask

Primary Ask	(specific bill, amendment, vote, or action you want)
Bill Number	(if exists)
Alternative Ask	(if primary ask fails)
Why This Legislator	(committee, district, past positions)
Deadline / Vote Date	

4. Three Strongest Evidence Points

Evidence #1	(statistic + source)
Evidence #2	(document, research finding + source)
Evidence #3	(comparable jurisdiction or expert citation + source)

5. Community Testimony (75 words max)

First-person account from a directly affected community member.

6. Endorsing Organizations

Organization	Contact	Type	Authorization

7. Anticipated Opposition & Responses

Expected Counterargument	Our Response

8. Contact & Follow-Up

Primary Contact	(name, phone, email)
Organization	
Meeting Request Sent	Yes / No — Date: _____
Follow-up Date	
Legislator Response	

TIP: Brief is a door-opener. Request a 15-minute meeting. Bring 3 people: a spokesperson, a community member with a personal story, and a policy expert.